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Ever since computing devices picked up in India, HP has been a part of that journey. Maintaining a strong market share amidst the declining PC market shipments in India for the past two years, HP has been the market leader in India's PC market with 31.5% market share, in both commercial and consumer segments in 2023, according to market intelligence firm IDC. Showcasing resilience and stability, the company is now expanding its manufacturing footprint in India. Helming the company's operations in India is Ipsita Dasgupta, an alumna of Harvard Business School and Columbia University, who has had stints at companies such as Apple, GE and IBM. Dasgupta, 47, who was appointed Senior Vice President and Managing Director of HP India less than a year ago, says an AI PC can create value for its users. In an interview with *Nidhi Singal*, Dasgupta talks about the relevance of the India market for HP, its growth strategy for the coming years and her vision for the company. Edited excerpts:

Q: Where does India stand for HP overall? Last year, HP's market share in India was 31.5%. What is the target for this year or two years down the line?

A: I can't speak about the market share. [But] I am happy to say that we're the market leaders and that we are India's beloved brand as I like to put it. I say this very often: 'HP is good for India, but India is great for HP.' What I mean by that is the way India is innovating, it is the future workforce and consumer base of the

world. The way India is expanding in things like SMB and entrepreneurship and new business models, it's inspiring for HP to think about growth markets like India to drive what the future of HP's business should look like. And as a company that has always played across all of India—from working with jobbers on printing solutions to ensure that [their] daily livelihood is met, and that we provide the right customer support and services all the way to very high-end gaming devices or enterprise PC devices—we play across the entire spectrum. That makes India extremely important. As you probably know, four days after I joined the company (Dasgupta joined HP on October 30, 2023), the global board of HP arrived in India to have their first-ever board meeting outside of the US, which is an indication to you... for an entire board to spend five days in this market just absorbing and understanding the potential of this market. So, there is no question that India is great for HP and very important to HP.

Q: How does your earlier work experience inform your strategy at HP?

A: I have been across six companies now, across multiple industries, ranging from media to consumer electronics to manufacturing. The value of someone like me coming into an industry, like the PC industry, is the ability to think a little bit about things that we're not already thinking about, models that we're not already thinking about. But also, to just be able to come into such a successful, huge platform that's been

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“The decision to sell refurbished PCs stems from two values—the idea of sustainability, and the idea of increasing accessibility and affordability”

built and think about how we can behave almost as a start-up and think about opportunities in the market that we can create.

If you think about PC penetration in India today, it's sub-20%. And yet when you think about the PC, it is really the core sort of device on which you can generate work or create work and learn. So, if I were to use an example to say, if you walked into a room, and you saw three children sitting on three different types